FOUNDERS HOUSE · MASTERCLASS · 20 NOVEMBER

The Know Enough Map.

You don't need to be the operator. You need to know enough to know when.

PANEL	GOOD ENOUGH	BRING SOMEONE IN WHEN	WHO: SMALLEST STEP FIRST	THE QUESTION TO ASK	WATCH FOR	SCORE
Finance	Books up to date monthly. Cash known three months ahead. Tax deadlines in the diary.	You can't say what cash you'll have. Raising money. Tax gets complicated.	Bookkeeper → accountant → part-time finance director → CFO	"Monthly management accounts and a three-month cash view, for a fixed fee?"	Strategy and fundraising support when you need clean books.	R A G
Legal	A founders' agreement. Standard customer terms. The company owns its IP. You've read what you signed.	A contract you don't understand. Investment or a dispute. Another country.	Templates → solicitor, one question → specialist → in-house counsel	"Review clauses X and Y for our liability and exit; no full review needed."	A full review or retainer when you need one clause answered.	R A G
People	Contracts and right-to-work checks. Payroll and pensions running. Clear roles.	First performance problem. Someone has to leave. Hiring abroad.	Payroll provider → HR adviser → employment solicitor → head of people	"What fair process do we follow, and what do we write down?"	A full HR system and policy library at ten people.	R A G
Commercial	Margin known on what you sell. Payment terms in writing. A visible pipeline.	Only you can sell. Can't forecast next quarter. CRM nobody trusts.	Freelancer → rev ops specialist → sales lead → head of revenue	"Set up our pipeline by stage and a next-quarter forecast. Nothing more."	A full rev ops stack before you have a repeatable sale.	R A G
Process	Repeating work written down. Everyone knows where things live.	The same mistake keeps happening. New starters take weeks to get going.	Ops-minded team member → freelancer → operations manager	"Map how this gets done today and write it so a new starter can follow it."	New software to fix a process nobody has agreed.	R A G
Compliance	Filing deadlines known and owned. Data protection basics. Insurance in place.	Regulated sector. Sensitive data. Selling abroad.	Accountant or company secretarial service → data protection adviser → regulatory specialist	"Which obligations apply to us, by date, and which are we missing?"	Certifications you don't need yet.	R A G
Governance	Who can decide and spend what, written down. Shareholder decisions recorded.	Outside investors. A board forming. Co-founders disagree.	Accountant or company secretary → corporate solicitor → non-executive director	"Which decisions need shareholder or board approval under our documents?"	A full board structure before you need one.	R A G
Risk	The five things that could hurt most, each with an owner. Insurance matches them.	You depend on one client or one person. A big new contract. An incident.	Insurance broker → relevant specialist → operations lead	"Given these five risks, are we covered, and where are the gaps?"	Blanket cover for risks you don't have.	R A G

Draft · general guidance for UK businesses. Not legal, tax or financial advice: when it matters, ask a qualified professional.

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BACK OF THE MAP

The brief.

1 · THE PROBLEM, IN ONE LINE
What's happening, in plain words.

2 · THE DECISION I NEED
What I'll decide with your answer.

3 · OUT OF SCOPE
What I'm not asking for.

4 · FEE CAP, AND BY WHEN
Budget or fixed fee, and the deadline.

THIS WEEK

One red.

1. Score every row red, amber or green.

2. Pick one red.

3. Write the brief for it, on the left.

4. Send it to the smallest right person on the ladder.

Not this: "Can you have a look at our contracts?"

This: "Our biggest client contract renews next month. We need to know if clauses 8 and 12 let them exit early and what we'd owe. We don't need a full review. Fixed fee, answer by Friday."

Operations Fundamentals takes the whole ball, one panel at a time. Start with OF101.